



SCIENCE IS THE PATH TO KNOWLEDGE, AND FINDING OUT ABOUT HOW OUR UNIVERSE WORKS. YOU CAN'T BE A GEEK AND NOT KNOW YOUR SCIENCE!

Do you even science?

WE'VE GOT THE GEEK ROUTE TO SCIENCE COVERED We're going to kickstart this section by looking at the origins of us Indians, the latest in nanotechnology, exercises to avoid text claw, admit our ignorance about the origin of life, check out some new space age suits and find out all about Team Indus...

The \$500 Billion plan to save the arctic

The polar caps are melting, and they've been on the decline for quite some time. Most of us millennials have been reading about the melting ice caps since our early school days and that hasn't stopped over the years. Over the years, we've banned some of the culprits such as CFC Aerosols and dampened the rate at which the ice caps were reducing but these ended up being half-measures. However, there's a new idea by Steve Desch, Professor of Astrophysics at the School of Earth & Space Exploration at Arizona State University that shows promise. It entails building 10 million wind-powered pumps across the Arctic ice cap which would pump water onto the surface of the ice cap in winter to help thicken it. So what's



the catch? It needs \$500 billion dollars to materialise.

Desch outlines his plan in a research article called "Arctic Ice Management" in the journal *Earth's Future*. He emphasises upon the urgency of the issue as estimates peg that the summer Arctic could be ice-free as soon as the 2030s.

<http://dgit.in/Arctic500>

Prehistoric diseases return

Humans and diseases have been doing the tango throughout history. We have evolved to resist pathogens and they, in turn, have evolved to find new ways to infect us.

Then about a century ago, Alexander Fleming happened. He is, of course, the man who discovered penicillin. Thanks to him we've had antibiotics to fight off those pesky bacteria. But bacteria are evolving to resist antibiotics too. It's an endless loop, a back-and-forth that maintains an equilibrium of sorts. But the balance might tip in the favour of bacteria and viruses soon.

As the permafrost melts, ancient viruses and bacteria which have been dormant for ages are being released from their icy prisons.

<http://dgit.in/icyBacteria>

